

PSY405 - Lesson 38

ALBERT ELLIS – THEORY OF PERSONALITY

Albert Ellis basically said one bold thing:

“People don’t get emotionally disturbed because of events.
They get disturbed because of how they THINK about those events.”

That’s it. That’s the core.

Everything else in the lesson is just explaining and applying this idea.

1 Irrational Beliefs – What are they?

Definition (simple):

Irrational beliefs are **illogical, unrealistic, extreme thoughts** that we believe so strongly that they mess up our emotions and behavior.

They usually contain words like:

- **must**
- **should**
- **always**
- **never**
- **everyone**
- **at any cost**

Examples from daily life

- “A black cat crossing my path means something bad WILL happen.”
- “Number 13 is unlucky.”
- “If I fail once, I am a failure forever.”
- “I must please my boss or I’m worthless.”

👉 These beliefs are **not facts**. They're **stories our brain tells us**.

2 Where do these irrational beliefs come from?

Ellis says we **learn them**. Nobody is born thinking "I must be perfect".

Sources (socialization):

Socialization = the process by which we learn beliefs, values, and behaviors from society.

We learn irrational beliefs from:

- Parents ("Log kya kahenge")
- Teachers ("Only toppers are successful")
- Friends & peers
- Religion (when misinterpreted)
- Culture & traditions
- Media, films, books, social media

💡 Over time, these beliefs become **automatic**. We don't even question them.

3 The BIG misunderstanding Ellis corrects

Most people think:

| Event → Emotion

Example:

| "I failed → I became depressed"

Ellis says **✗** WRONG.

Instead:

| Event → Belief → Emotion

This leads us to the famous...

4 A-B-C Theory (CORE CONCEPT)

A = Activating Event

Definition:

Any event that happens in your life.

Examples:

- Failing an exam
- Breakup
- Criticism from boss
- Not getting selected

👉 A itself is **neutral**. It has no emotion.

B = Belief

Definition:

What you **tell yourself** about the event.

This is the **most important part**.

Beliefs can be:

- **Rational (logical, flexible, realistic)**
 - **Irrational (illogical, extreme, rigid)**
-

C = Consequence

Definition:

Your emotional and behavioral reaction.

Examples:

- Depression
- Anxiety
- Anger

- Giving up
 - Avoidance
-

Example (Exam Failure)

A: I failed my midterm.

Irrational B:

- "I am dumb."
- "I will never pass."
- "I don't deserve to be here."

C:

Depression, hopelessness, quitting.

Rational B:

- "I was sick."
- "I didn't prepare well."
- "I can improve."

C:

Motivation, planning, studying harder.

👉 **Same event, different belief, totally different outcome.**

5 Why Ellis says beliefs cause psychopathology

Psychopathology (definition):

Mental disorders like:

- Depression
- Anxiety
- Neurosis
- Psychosis

Ellis says:

Events do NOT cause mental illness.

Rigid, irrational beliefs do.

6 Ellis's View of Human Nature

Ellis was realistic, not sugar-coating.

Humans have TWO potentials:

✓ Rationality

- Logical thinking
- Acceptance
- Growth
- Self-actualization (becoming your best self)

✗ Irrationality

- Superstitions
- Perfectionism
- Self-blame
- Avoidance
- Intolerance

We are **capable of both**, and we often choose the second without realizing it.

7 Ellis's Assumptions about Humans (important)

Let's simplify each:

1. Humans tend to think irrationally

We are **biologically and culturally wired** to exaggerate and overthink.

2. Humans create their own disturbance

We don't just *have* irrational beliefs — we **invent and repeat** them.

3. We condition ourselves

Conditioning = training yourself.

By repeating negative self-talk:

- "I'm useless"
- "I must succeed"

We train ourselves to suffer.

4. Humans can change

By changing:

- **Cognition** (thinking)
- **Emotion** (feeling)
- **Behavior** (actions)

We can stay **less disturbed for life**.

5. Self-talk causes emotional problems

Constant self-judgment leads to:

- Need for approval
 - Fear of failure
 - Lack of self-growth
-

8 Biological & Social Factors in Personality

Biological Factors

Some people are **naturally more sensitive**.

Example:

- "I always fail"
 - Severe disorders like **schizophrenia** (thinking disorder) have biological roots.
-

Social Factors

Acceptance vs criticism shapes self-worth.

- Accepted → "I matter"
- Criticized → "I am worthless"

But Ellis says:

👉 **Depending on others for worth is irrational.**

9 Extended A-B-C → A-B-C-D-E Model

Ellis later added two steps.

D = Disputing

Definition:

Actively challenging irrational beliefs.

Three steps:

- **Detecting** (find the belief)
 - **Discriminating** (is it rational or irrational?)
 - **Debating** (where's the proof?)
-

E = Effect

Definition:

New rational belief → healthier emotion → better behavior.

Example:

Reema feels depressed after failure.

D:

"Is it true that one failure makes me worthless?"

"Where is the evidence?"

E:

She studies again, feels hopeful, improves performance.

10 Irrational Beliefs – The Dangerous "Musts"

Ellis noticed a pattern.

Irrational beliefs often sound like:

- "I must..."
- "I should..."
- "I am to be blamed..."

These beliefs lead to:

- Depression
 - Anxiety
 - Self-hatred
 - Neurosis (emotional disturbance)
 - Psychosis (severe mental disturbance)
-

Common Irrational Beliefs (simplified)

1. Everyone must love me
2. I must always succeed
3. People who disagree are bad
4. Rejection is catastrophic
5. I have no control over emotions
6. Fearful things are unbearable
7. Avoiding responsibility is easier

8. Past controls my future
9. Problems must have perfect solutions
10. Happiness = doing nothing
11. Life must go my way
12. My worth depends on approval

Ellis says: **✗ All wrong. All harmful.**

1 1 REBT – Rational Emotive Behavior Therapy

Definition:

A therapy that helps people **identify, challenge, and replace irrational beliefs** with rational ones.

Therapeutic Process (step-by-step)

1. Build rapport (trust)
 2. Identify irrational beliefs
 3. Show how they're illogical
 4. Challenge them
 5. Use humor (Ellis loved humor)
 6. Replace with rational beliefs
 7. Practice using techniques
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1 2 Techniques of REBT

Cognitive Techniques (thinking)

- Disputing beliefs
 - Homework
 - Changing language ("must" → "prefer")
-

Behavioral Techniques (doing)

- Role playing
 - Exposure
 - Homework
 - Modeling (learning by observing)
-

Emotional Techniques (feeling)

- Rational emotive imagery
 - Role playing emotional situations
 - No excessive sympathy (Ellis believed sympathy can reinforce weakness)
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Goals of REBT

REBT aims to build:

- Self-acceptance
- Flexibility
- Tolerance
- Independence
- Acceptance of uncertainty

Basically: **a strong, realistic adult mind.**

Applications of REBT

Used for:

- Anxiety
- Depression
- Anger
- Marriage issues

- Parenting
 - Social skills
 - Self-management
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FINAL TAKEAWAY (MENTOR TALK)

Ellis is telling you something powerful:

Life will always be messy.
But your suffering is optional.

You can't control events.

You **can** control your beliefs.

And once you do —

you don't just pass exams,

you pass life.

Q1: Who was Albert Ellis and what is his contribution to personality psychology?

Answer:

Albert Ellis (1913–2007) was an American psychologist who developed **Rational Emotive Behavior Therapy (REBT)**. He is famous for proposing that **irrational beliefs are the root of emotional disturbances**, such as anxiety and depression. Ellis introduced the **A-B-C model** to explain how thoughts, rather than events, cause emotional and behavioral outcomes. He wrote over 60 books and 700 articles and founded the Rational Motive Therapy Institute to train professionals and promote self-help strategies.

Explanation:

Ellis believed that our mind creates emotional problems. Instead of blaming events or situations, he focused on the way we interpret them. His work shifted psychology from just analyzing symptoms to **actively changing thinking patterns** to improve life.

Example:

Failing an exam doesn't automatically make you depressed. Thinking "I am a failure and will never succeed" leads to depression. If you think, "I can learn from this and improve," you feel motivated instead.

Tips:

- Remember: **Ellis = Thoughts → Feelings → Behavior**.
 - Focus on REBT as a **solution-oriented therapy** rather than just analysis.
-

Q2: What are irrational beliefs according to Ellis?

Answer:

Irrational beliefs are illogical, unrealistic, rigid thoughts that lead to emotional disturbance. They often include **words like must, should, always, never**, and involve extreme thinking about oneself, others, or the world. These beliefs are **learned socially** from parents, teachers, peers, culture, and media.

Explanation:

Irrational beliefs are the mental "stories" we tell ourselves. They are **not facts** but strongly believed ideas that make life harder. They are the foundation of anxiety, depression, and self-defeating behavior.

Example:

- "I must always be successful" → Leads to stress and self-blame when failure occurs.
- "Everyone must love me" → Causes hurt when someone criticizes you.

Tips:

- Notice the **repetition of must/should** in your thoughts.
 - Track where these beliefs came from—family, school, or social norms.
-

Q3: Explain the A-B-C theory of personality.

Answer:

Ellis's **A-B-C theory** explains emotional and behavioral outcomes as follows:

- **A = Activating Event:** Any event that happens in life.
- **B = Belief:** How we interpret the event (rational or irrational).
- **C = Consequence:** Emotional or behavioral reaction.

Ellis argued that **C is caused by B, not A**. Later, he expanded it to **A-B-C-D-E**, adding:

- **D = Disputing:** Challenging irrational beliefs.
- **E = Effect:** The positive outcome after changing beliefs.

Explanation:

The model shows that events themselves don't create emotional problems. Our **belief system shapes our reaction**. By challenging irrational beliefs (D) and replacing them with rational ones, we can produce healthier effects (E).

Example:

- **A:** Failing a midterm exam.
- **Irrational B:** "I am worthless and will never pass."
- **C:** Depression, hopelessness.
- **Disputing D:** "Is it true I am worthless? Can I learn from this?"
- **Effect E:** Motivation to study and improve.

Tips:

- Remember: **A = Event, B = Belief, C = Consequence, D = Debate, E = Effect**.
- Practice identifying your **own ABCs** in daily life.

Q4: What is the role of irrational beliefs in emotional disturbance?

Answer:

Irrational beliefs are the **main cause of emotional disturbances** like anxiety, depression, anger, and self-doubt. They make individuals **internalize failure**,

blame themselves excessively, and expect perfection from themselves and others. These beliefs often create **neurosis (mild mental disturbance)** and in severe cases, **psychosis (serious mental disorders)**.

Explanation:

When we believe extreme, unrealistic thoughts, we feel negative emotions unnecessarily. Instead of addressing reality, we focus on **our distorted interpretations**. Over time, this reinforces negative habits and emotions.

Example:

- "I must win this award at all costs." → Stress and disappointment if you lose.
- "I am responsible for everything that goes wrong." → Constant guilt and anxiety.

Tips:

- Watch for words like "must," "should," or "everyone."
 - Ask yourself: "Is this belief **logical or realistic**?"
-

Q5: What are some common irrational beliefs identified by Ellis?

Answer:

Some common irrational beliefs include:

1. I must be loved and approved by everyone.
2. I must always succeed and be competent.
3. People who disagree are bad.
4. Rejection or unfair treatment is catastrophic.
5. My past determines my present and future.
6. Happiness comes from inactivity or avoiding responsibility.
7. My worth depends on others' approval.

Explanation:

These beliefs are rigid and unrealistic. They push people to **self-blame, perfectionism, and emotional misery**, blocking personal growth.

Example:

- "I am worthless because someone criticized me."
- "If I fail, my whole life is ruined."

Tips:

- Identify which of these beliefs you **repeat internally**.
- Reframe them with rational alternatives: "I prefer to succeed, but failure is a chance to learn."

Q6: What is Rational Emotive Behavior Therapy (REBT) and its therapeutic process?

Answer:

REBT is a therapy designed to **identify, challenge, and replace irrational beliefs with rational ones**. The therapy involves:

1. Building **rappport** with the client.
2. Identifying irrational beliefs.
3. Showing how these beliefs are **illogical**.
4. Challenging the client to validate or dispute their beliefs.
5. Using **humor** to confront rigid thinking.
6. Replacing irrational ideas with rational, realistic ones.
7. Applying **cognitive, emotional, and behavioral techniques** to reinforce change.

Explanation:

REBT works on the principle that by changing thoughts, emotions and behaviors automatically improve. Therapists don't just give advice—they **teach clients to think differently**.

Example:

- Client believes: "I must be perfect in everything I do."
- Therapist helps them dispute: "Is perfection realistic? What if I do my best?"
- Result: Less stress, healthier self-esteem.

Tips:

- Focus on **self-talk** and challenge every extreme thought.
 - Use daily journaling to practice ABCDE steps.
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Q7: What techniques are used in REBT?

Answer:

REBT uses **three types of techniques**:

1. Cognitive (thinking)

- Disputing irrational beliefs
- Homework exercises
- Changing language ("I must" → "I prefer")

2. Behavioral (action)

- Role-playing challenging situations
- Self-management and exposure
- Modeling (learning from examples)

3. Emotional (feeling)

- Rational Emotive Imagery (imagining scenarios to change feelings)
- Role-playing emotional reactions

Explanation:

The therapy doesn't only talk about thoughts—it **acts on thinking, behavior, and emotion**. This three-way approach strengthens learning and real-life application.

Example:

- Cognitive: Journal "I am not perfect"

- Behavioral: Speak up in a group even if scared
- Emotional: Visualize handling criticism calmly

Tips:

- Practice all three: think differently, act differently, feel differently.
 - Start small—real-life application is key.
-

Q8: What are the goals of REBT?

Answer:

The main goals of REBT are:

1. Minimize **self-defeating, irrational outlooks**.
2. Develop **realistic life philosophy**.
3. Increase **self-interest, social interest, tolerance, flexibility, and commitment**.
4. Accept **uncertainty** and reduce emotional disturbances.

Explanation:

REBT doesn't just treat symptoms—it **teaches a life skill**: how to respond rationally and maturely to life's challenges.

Example:

- Instead of "I must win," you think "I prefer to do my best."
- Instead of blaming yourself for rejection, you accept life has ups and downs.

Tips:

- Aim for **self-acceptance over perfection**.
 - Practice replacing "must" statements with "prefer" statements.
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Q9: What are the applications of REBT?

Answer:

REBT can be applied to:

- **Anxiety and depression**
- **Anger and hostility**
- **Marital and relationship issues**
- **Parenting and child-rearing**
- **Self-management**
- **Social skills training**

Explanation:

Because REBT targets irrational thinking, it's useful in **any area where extreme or unrealistic beliefs create emotional or behavioral problems.**

Example:

- An anxious student: "I must get top grades" → REBT helps reduce stress and improve study habits.
- Parents: "My child should always behave perfectly" → REBT reduces conflict and guilt.

Tips:

- Apply the ABCDE model to daily challenges.
- Use role-play and journaling for practice.

Q10: Summarize Ellis's theory of personality.

Answer:

Ellis believed that **irrational beliefs are the foundation of emotional disturbance.** Personality is shaped by biological tendencies and social experiences, but **the way we interpret events (beliefs) determines our emotional responses.** His **A-B-C-D-E model** helps identify and replace irrational beliefs with rational ones, leading to healthier emotions and behavior. REBT provides a structured way to **transform thinking, emotion, and behavior.**

Explanation:

Instead of blaming life or circumstances, Ellis teaches that **we control our thoughts**. Rational thinking leads to rational emotions, which leads to effective behavior—forming the basis of a healthy personality.

Example:

- Irrational: “I failed, therefore I am worthless” → leads to depression
- Rational: “I failed, but I can learn and improve” → leads to motivation and confidence

Tips:

- Always track your **ABC patterns** in real life.
- Challenge “musts” and extreme thinking immediately.

LONG QUESTION ANSWERS

Q1: Discuss the life, contributions, and theory of personality of Albert Ellis.

Answer:

1. Biographical Sketch

- **Born:** 1913, Pittsburgh, USA
- **Education:** MA and Ph.D. from Columbia University
- **Childhood:** Eldest of three; frequently hospitalized for kidney problems
- **Early traits:** Developed independence and self-responsibility (made own meals, went to school alone)
- **Professional life:**
 - Practiced **psychoanalysis (1947–1953)** but found it ineffective
 - Developed **Rational Emotive Behavior Therapy (REBT)** in the 1950s
 - Authored **725 articles and 60 books**

- Founded **Rational Motive Therapy Institute** in 1959

2. Contributions to Psychology

- Proposed **irrational beliefs are the root cause of emotional disturbances**
- Developed the **A-B-C model** of personality (later expanded to A-B-C-D-E)
- Introduced **REBT**, the first cognitive-behavioral therapy
- Emphasized **rational thinking over automatic emotional reactions**
- Promoted **self-help techniques** for public mental health

3. Theory of Personality

Ellis's personality theory combines:

- **Biological factors** – innate tendencies to react emotionally
- **Social factors** – learned beliefs from family, culture, peers
- **Cognitive factors** – interpretation of events through rational or irrational beliefs

Core Principle:

| Personality is shaped less by events and more by beliefs about events.

Explanation (Plain English)

Ellis grew up learning self-reliance because of health challenges and absent parents. Professionally, he was frustrated with psychoanalysis because it never freed clients from symptoms. He realized that **emotions follow thoughts**, not events. So he created REBT to **teach people how to change thinking patterns**, which ultimately changes emotions and behavior.

Example:

- A student fails an exam. Instead of thinking "I am worthless," REBT encourages: "I can learn and improve next time."

Tip:

- Remember: **Ellis = Thoughts → Feelings → Behavior.**

- Focus on his **A-B-C model** as the backbone of his personality theory.

Q2: Explain Albert Ellis's views on human nature and irrational beliefs.

Answer:

1. Human Nature

Ellis believed humans have **dual potential**:

Potential	Characteristics	Examples
Rational	Logical, positive, self-accepting, capable of growth	Thinking: "I can improve" → Motivated behavior
Irrational	Crooked thinking, perfectionism, self-blame, superstitious	Thinking: "I must succeed in everything" → Anxiety, depression

2. Key Assumptions about Humans

1. People are **biologically and culturally predisposed to irrational thinking**
2. Individuals **invent their own irrational beliefs** and keep disturbing themselves
3. Emotional disturbance is **self-created**, not just caused by environment
4. Humans **can change themselves** through cognition, emotion, and behavior
5. **Self-talk** and constant evaluation can hinder personal growth and self-actualization

3. Irrational Beliefs

- Defined as **unrealistic, rigid thoughts** leading to emotional problems
- Often involve **"must," "should," "always," "never"**
- Lead to **self-defeating behaviors**, anxiety, depression, or neurosis

Common irrational beliefs:

1. Everyone must love me
2. I must always succeed

3. People who disagree are bad
 4. Rejection is catastrophic
 5. Happiness is external
 6. Past controls future
 7. Life must go my way
-

Explanation (Plain English)

Ellis says we are born **capable of rationality and irrationality**. We often pick irrationality without realizing it. These beliefs are not facts—they are **stories we tell ourselves**. Once repeated, they form habits of negative thinking, which distort our emotions and behavior.

Example:

- Belief: "I must win this award" → Emotional consequence: stress and anxiety
- Rational alternative: "I prefer to do my best, outcomes may vary" → Healthy emotion and motivation

Tips:

- Listen for **"must" or "should"** in your thoughts
 - Practice turning them into **preferences**: "I prefer" or "I would like"
-

Q3: Describe the A-B-C theory of personality with examples and its extension to A-B-C-D-E.

Answer:

1. A-B-C Model

- **A = Activating Event**

Any life event that happens. Neutral by itself.

- **B = Belief**

Individual's interpretation of the event (rational or irrational).

- **C = Consequence**

Emotional and behavioral reaction, caused by **B**, not **A**.

Example Table:

Event (A)	Irrational Belief (B)	Consequence (C)	Rational Belief (B)	Consequence (C)
Failing exam	"I am worthless"	Depression, hopelessness	"I can learn and improve"	Motivation, hope, planning

2. Extension: A-B-C-D-E Model

- **D = Disputing** – Challenging irrational beliefs (detect, discriminate, debate)
- **E = Effect** – Result of rational thinking; healthier emotion and behavior

Example:

- **A:** Missed a project deadline
- **B:** "I am a failure"
- **C:** Anxiety, self-blame
- **D:** "Is it true I'm a failure? Can I improve?"
- **E:** Plan better time management → Confidence restored

Explanation (Plain English)

Ellis's ABC model shows that **events alone do not cause emotional problems**. It's the **beliefs we attach to events** that matter. The D-E addition provides a **practical step for therapy**, showing how to challenge irrational beliefs and create a rational outcome.

Tip:

- Practice identifying your own ABCDE in daily situations
- Write irrational beliefs in a journal and dispute them regularly

Q4: Explain the Rational Emotive Behavior Therapy (REBT) process, techniques, goals, and applications.

Answer:

1. Therapeutic Process

1. **Build rapport** with client (trust and understanding)
2. Identify **irrational beliefs**
3. Demonstrate **illogical nature** of beliefs
4. Challenge client to **validate/dispute** their beliefs
5. Use **humor** to reduce rigidity
6. Replace irrational ideas with **rational alternatives**
7. Use **cognitive, emotional, and behavioral techniques** for reinforcement

2. Techniques

Technique Type	Description	Examples
Cognitive	Change thinking	Disputing irrational beliefs, cognitive homework, changing language ("must" → "prefer")
Behavioral	Change actions	Role-playing, self-management, exposure, modeling, behavioral homework
Emotional	Change feelings	Rational emotive imagery, role-playing emotional situations

3. Goals

- Minimize self-defeating, irrational thoughts
- Develop realistic life philosophy
- Increase self-acceptance, social interest, tolerance, flexibility
- Accept uncertainty and reduce emotional disturbance

4. Applications

- Treat anxiety, depression, anger
 - Marital and relationship counseling
 - Parenting and child-rearing
 - Self-management and social skills training
-

Explanation (Plain English)

REBT is a **hands-on therapy** that works on three levels: **thoughts, actions, and emotions**. The therapist guides clients to **identify faulty thinking, challenge it, and replace it with rational alternatives**, using both conversation and practical exercises. It's not about sympathy—it's about **training the mind to respond better**.

Example:

- Cognitive: "I must be perfect" → Write "I prefer to do my best"
- Behavioral: Practice giving a speech despite fear
- Emotional: Visualize handling criticism calmly

Tips:

- Apply **ABC-D-E steps in daily life**, not just therapy
 - Track beliefs in a **journal** and dispute every extreme "must" thought
-

Q5: Discuss the evaluation and significance of Ellis's theory of personality.

Answer:

1. Evaluation

- **Strengths:**
 - Practical, solution-focused approach
 - Directly addresses emotional and behavioral problems
 - Empowers clients to **change themselves**

- Applicable to various disorders and life problems
- **Weaknesses:**
 - May **underestimate the role of environment** in causing distress
 - Requires high motivation from clients
 - Not always suitable for severe mental illness without additional support

2. Significance

- First cognitive-behavioral approach, influencing modern therapies
- Emphasizes **self-responsibility** and rational thinking
- Provides **structured tools (ABC-D-E)** for changing thought patterns
- Promotes **prevention of emotional disturbances** through rational thinking

Explanation (Plain English)

Ellis's theory is revolutionary because it **puts the power in your hands**. You can't control everything in life, but you can **control your beliefs**. By learning to think rationally, emotional disturbances like anxiety, depression, and anger can be minimized. It's practical, actionable, and widely applicable.

Example:

- Instead of blaming life for failures, individuals **take control of their beliefs** and respond constructively.

Tip:

- Learn ABCDE and **practice every day**.
- Use real-life problems as "practice drills" for REBT.

CHEAT SHEET

Key Terms & Definitions

Term	Definition (Plain English)	Example
Irrational Belief	Illogical, extreme thought that causes emotional disturbance	"I must be loved by everyone"
Rational Belief	Logical, realistic thought leading to healthy emotion	"I prefer to be liked, but it's okay if not everyone likes me"
A-B-C Model	Framework showing how beliefs (B), not events (A), cause consequences (C)	Failing exam (A) → "I am worthless" (B) → Depression (C)
ABCDE Model	Extended model adding D = Dispute & E = Effect	Dispute: "Is it true I'm worthless?" → Effect: Motivation to improve
Activating Event (A)	Any event in life	Failing midterm
Belief (B)	Interpretation of event	"I am a failure"
Consequence (C)	Emotional/behavioral outcome	Anxiety, depression
Disputing (D)	Challenge irrational belief	"Can I prove I'm a failure?"
Effect (E)	Result of rational belief	Motivation, confidence
REBT	Therapy to replace irrational beliefs with rational ones	Cognitive homework, role-play, rational imagery
Neurosis	Mild mental/emotional disturbance	Anxiety, worry, low self-esteem
Psychosis	Severe mental disturbance with impaired reality	Schizophrenia, delusions

2 Common Irrational Beliefs (Focus on MUSTs)

- Everyone **must** love me
- I **must** succeed in everything
- People who disagree are **bad**
- Rejection is **catastrophic**
- My past **determines** my present

- Happiness comes from **external factors**
- Life **must** go my way

Memory Hook: "MUST BAD PAST"

- **M**ust always succeed
- **U**niversal love required
- **S**elf-worth depends on approval
- **T**hings must go my way
- **B**ad people = bad outcomes
- **A**nxiety over rejection
- **S**uperstitions
- **T**rauma past controls present

3 ABCDE Model – Quick Table

Step	Meaning	Question to Ask	Example
A	Activating Event	What happened?	Failed exam
B	Belief	What am I telling myself?	"I am worthless"
C	Consequence	How do I feel & behave?	Depression
D	Disputing	Is this belief logical?	"Can I prove I'm worthless?"
E	Effect	What's the new outcome?	Study harder, motivated

Tip: Always write ABCDE for any stressful situation; it's your mental toolkit.

4 Human Nature – Ellis's View

Aspect	Characteristics	Examples
Rational	Positive, logical, self-accepting, growth-oriented	"I can improve next time"

Aspect	Characteristics	Examples
Irrational	Crooked thinking, perfectionist, self-blame, superstitions	"I must never fail"

Ellis Assumptions:

1. Humans **naturally think irrationally**
2. Emotional disturbance is **self-created**
3. We **can change** by altering cognition, emotion, and behavior

Memory Hook: "Rational vs Irrational = Control vs Chaos"

5 REBT Therapeutic Process

1. Build rapport (trust)
2. Identify irrational beliefs
3. Show illogical nature
4. Challenge & validate beliefs
5. Use humor to reduce rigidity
6. Replace with rational beliefs
7. Apply cognitive, emotional, behavioral techniques

Techniques:

Type	Description	Example
Cognitive	Change thinking patterns	Dispute "must" thoughts, homework
Behavioral	Change actions	Role-play, exposure, behavioral homework
Emotional	Change feelings	Rational emotive imagery, emotional role-play

Tip: Use **all three together** for best results.

6 Goals of REBT

- Minimize self-defeating thoughts

- Develop realistic life philosophy
- Increase tolerance, flexibility, social interest
- Accept uncertainty and reduce emotional disturbance

Mnemonic: "REAL"

- **R**ational thinking
- **E**emotionally healthy
- **A**accept uncertainty
- **L**ive realistically

7 Applications of REBT

- Anxiety and depression treatment
- Anger and hostility control
- Marital and relationship counseling
- Parenting and child-rearing guidance
- Self-management and social skills training

Example:

- Shy student → Role-play presentations → Gains confidence
- Parent blaming self → Cognitive restructuring → Better parenting

9 Examples

Scenario	Irrational Belief	Rational Belief	Consequence
Failed exam	"I am a failure"	"I can learn and improve"	Motivation, planning
Boss criticized me	"I must always please my boss"	"I prefer to do my best"	Calm, constructive response
Lost competition	"Life must go my way"	"I'd like to succeed, but setbacks happen"	Reduced stress, adaptability